4

The Toungoo (1531–1599) and Restored Toungoo Dynasties (1599–1752)

MIN-GYI-NYO, TABINSHWETI, AND THE FOUNDING OF THE TOUNGOO DYNASTY

The origins of the Toungoo dynasty lie in the downfall of the Ava dynasty. Toungoo emerged toward the end of the Ava dynasty when Burman refugees migrated southward to the Sittang valley following successive invasions of the Mong Yang Shan during the 1480s. The Burmese chronicles also recorded the Mong Yang Shan's conquest of Ava. During 1501–1502, Yamethin elites migrated south to Toungoo following a purge of the royal court after the assassination of the ruler of Yamethin.

King Min-gyi-nyo seized the throne of Toungoo in 1486 after murdering his uncle King Si-thu-nge. He then married the daughter of the king of Ava and was given Toungoo to rule. During the early 1490s, Min-gyi-nyo built a new capital and established himself as a military commander. After the Mon king Dhammazedi died in 1492, Min-gyi-nyo attacked settlements along the frontier between Ava and Toungoo. A year later, he attacked Kyaung-pya on the Toungoo-Ramanya frontier. During 1503–1504, Min-gyi-nyo made the decision to depopulate the settlements he was given by the king of Ava.

Sometime between 1505 and 1506, Min-gyi-nyo forged an alliance with the cities of Prome and Taungdwingi. For the next five years, he waged a series of campaigns around the region near Bagan. In 1510, King Min-gyi-nyo founded the first Toungoo dynasty at Toungoo. It was Min-gyi-nyo's son and heir King Tabinshweti (r. ca. 1531–1556) who consolidated control over both Upper and Lower Burma, uniting most of Burma when he captured the port city of Bassein and defeated the Mon capital of Pegu.